



Increase the Effectiveness of Your Emails PART 2

On Email Timing and Partnering Email with Social Media

OSIT
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The Subject Line
& Email Body



Imagine you give a business that you like your contact info, and all of the sudden they start

texting you twice a week, every week. You probably won't like them much anymore.

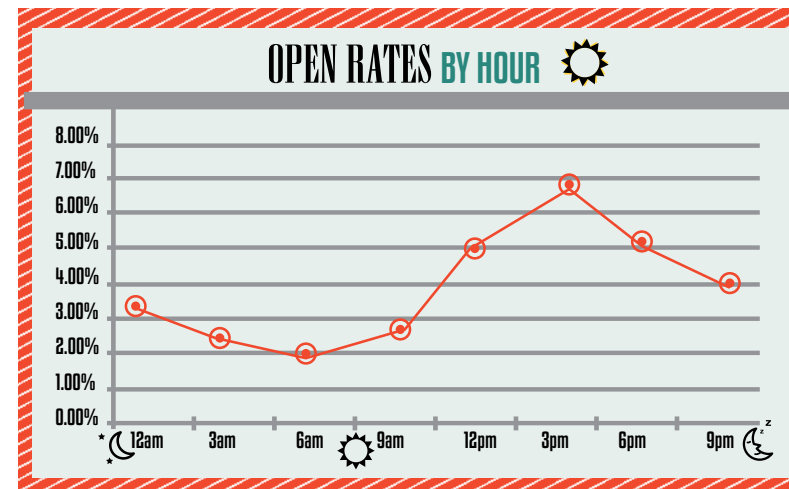
Your communication efforts can make or break your relationship with a business, and it can make or break the relationship between your baalei batim (and prospective baalei batim) and your Chabad House.

Below is a compilation and synopsis of up-to-date research on best practices to help you get the most out of your Chabad House emails and social media.

EMAIL SCHEDULING

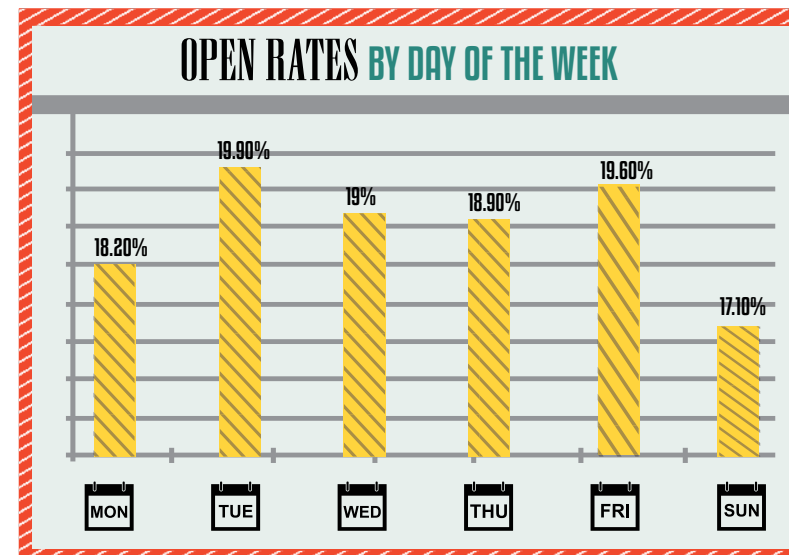
Best Time of Day

Many emails are opened within an hour of getting them, and after 24 hours, an email's chance of being opened drops below one percent! If timing is off, your email will probably end up in the trash. Readers are more likely to open emails after 12 pm. Lunchtime and evening seem to get the most click throughs, especially with younger audiences. Morning emails don't seem to get donations, so send your funding requests in the early evening.



Best Day of the Week

While best days to send emails are Tuesday and Friday, and any weekday is a bit better than the weekend, there is not a monumental difference in open rates between different days of the week. As such, you might want to consider the content more than day-of-the-week open rates when deciding when to send. For example, newsletters seem best received on weekends, since the reader needs time and headspace for them.



CONSIDER THE CONTENT

Since most people access their emails on a constant basis on their phones, it's important to send emails when they will be most interesting to the recipient. The email's content can help you decide when's a good time to send. Consider your objective, subject, and audience.

Objective: Your Goal as the Sender

➔ Action

For example, a registration email for the model matzah bakery, or a donation solicitation, which both bring the reader to act.

➔ Promotion

The email raises awareness, but you're satisfied if people don't click further right now. For example, a promo for an end-of-year campaign, but not pushing registration just yet.

➔ Entertainment

Emails like your weekly newsletter, which provide inspiration and insight to the reader. Ideally read over a few minutes.

Subject

Food-related emails make sense to send at mealtimes, while a summer camp promo should be sent once the summer buzz has started (not too early or late). Updates about an exciting upcoming event can be sent more often than the daily minyan email.

Audience

Since relevant content is never too much, keep it personal. Does your target audience work or stay home? How old are they? What are their interests? What is their daily schedule? Send emails only to relevant demographics. Mommy and Me emails should only go to young parents, promos for the JLI course on midlife crisis should only go to middle-aged couples, etc.

To Spam or Not to Spam?

On the one hand, you want to get your emails into people’s inboxes. It lets people know what you’re doing, and hopefully more people will get involved as a result. One the other hand, too much email makes people unsubscribe or ignore you.

While you might think the solution is to allow the subscriber to choose the frequency and type of email they want from the beginning, this doesn’t usually work. There’s a reason advertisers don’t ask people whether they should put ads on people’s TVs. People might not like it, but it works.

We need to strike the right balance between politely getting our messages out there and being unlikeable spammers.

Optimal Frequency

Generally, you want to show up in someone’s inbox 2-5 times a month, or if you’re not sure whether someone’s interested, every two weeks.

If a campaign or highlight event is launching, more emails are encouraged.

HERE’S A SAMPLE SCHEDULE:

THREE DAYS LATER	Send a promo with an exciting tidbit about the campaign.
ANOTHER TWO DAYS LATER	Send a reminder that the campaign begins tomorrow.
ON THE DAY OF THE CAMPAIGN	Send a morning reminder with a join-the-campaign button.
	Send updates over the course of the campaign every few hours. Use them to push more people to join.
	Bonus: If you can send update emails to those who’ve already given and encouragement to-join emails to those who haven’t yet given.
IF THE CAMPAIGN RUNS MORE THAN ONE DAY	Reduce the updates to two or three times a day instead of every few hours.

Respect Disinterest

Always have an unsubscribe button in your emails (Chabad.org supports this), but when readers click unsubscribe, give an option to choose fewer emails instead of none.

Reduce the email frequency of someone who rarely responds. Once or twice a month, try a general update of what’s going on, along with a short message. Send your “highlight” emails to everyone.

Test It Out

Don’t assume that the info above is perfect for every situation. It might need some tweaking for your Chabad House, or for a certain group within your Chabad House.

Choose a test group from your database that represents the spectrum of your target audience. Send them emails either more or less frequently than everyone else, or on different days or at different times. Review their open rates (how many people open the emails), click-through rates (how many people click your links and do the desired action you had intended), and unsubscribes *over time*, not for an individual event.

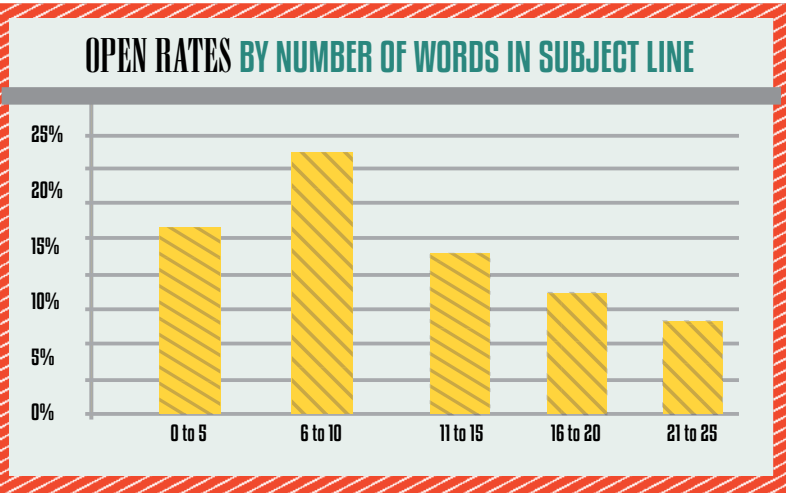
Mobile Devices

Can you guess what your readers do when you send them an email that isn’t optimized for mobile?

They delete it. In fact, 70 percent delete the email immediately! And yet, only 11 percent of email campaigns use responsive design to optimize their email layout.

Thirty-five percent of business professionals check email on a mobile device, and 51 percent of all emails are now opened and read on mobile devices. That’s a growth of 180 percent in three years, and the percentage continues to grow each quarter.

Have you seen your email template on a mobile device recently? If not, take a look. If you haven’t optimized your email campaigns for mobile devices yet, now is the time.



Subject Lines Matter

Thirty-five percent of email recipients open email based on the subject line alone. You should spend as much time writing your subject line as you spend on writing the content. A well crafted subject line shouldn’t just be the

first thing that comes to mind.
The length of your subject line is also important. Subject lines with six to ten words deliver the highest open rate, eight words being ideal. If a subject line is too long, it will get cut off, your reader won’t know what the email is about, and it is much more likely to get ignored.
Another tip: Subject lines personalized with a recipient’s first name can lift open rates by 20 percent!

Social Media

Social media is for general awareness and mass updates in a fun way. It’s unobtrusive and effective, especially for a younger audience, which is more interested in social media than in email marketing.

You can (should) be much more active on social media than in email. For example, a young adult shliach running a charity campaign would send a general announcement email, another one a day or two before, and another one or two on the day. But he would be busy on social media the whole time, many times a day, with updates, cute pushes to give, and targeted ads, plus encouragement to the community to share the message further. He and his community would also use texts to to contact people they know personally and direct them to the Facebook page and/or website.

Use social media as a driving force for your marketing, but don’t use it for highly technical info or lengthy personal messages. Stick to email for those.

TEENS

- Facebook:** 2 posts a day
- Instagram:** 3-4 posts a day
- Snapchat:** 3-4 posts a day
- Twitter:** Not a must, but can be nice. If you have it, post twice a day.

Other Helpful Tidbits

- Thirty percent of subscribers change email addresses annually, so update your contact list regularly.
- Many marketers don’t realize that the images in their emails are blocked by their recipients. This is a big problem, especially if some or all of your content is within the image (a flyer that you posted into the body of your email, for example). When marketers optimize their emails for image blocking, ROI increases by nine percent or more.
- Eighty-four percent of people ages 18-34 use an email pre-view pane, meaning they can see the beginning of your email without ever having to open it. If you want more opens, you have to make sure your intro is enticing.
- Subscribers below age 25 prefer texting to email.



Frequency

Try to have the number of content posts (the toichen people enjoy and want to share) at least five times more than promotional posts. When you share more content, people will be more likely to share your promotions.

In general, post more during events and less during quiet times.

There’s also a difference in recommended frequency between your personal social media account and the Chabad House one.

Frequency will also vary between different age groups.

(Note that replying to comments or tweets creates conversation and isn’t subject to these rules.)

MILLENNIALS

- Facebook:** For a Facebook group, post 5-6 times a week, versus 2-3 times a week for a Facebook page.
- Instagram:** If you can keep it up, post 5-7 times a week. If the community is around your Chabad House account you can use it, otherwise, use your personal account and post from the Chabad House account 3-4 times a week.
- Twitter:** Not a must, but can be nice. If you have it, post twice a day.

MIDDLE AGE

- Facebook:** 4-5 times a week
- Twitter:** Not a must, but can be nice. If you have it, post twice a day.
- These rules are a great guideline, but you know your Chabad House best. As always, use your judgement. Best wishes for stellar open rates! 🇺🇸

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